

Ambition in second generation immigrants

High achieving parents come to America hoping to give their children a chance at the good life they always wanted. Having been raised in an environment where they were expected to aim high and thrive, they've gotten a taste for success. They've seen how those around them who didn't strive for greatness stumbled into oblivion. So they tell their children they must strive so high to live the good life.

Only, the children have not seen what their parents have. The children grow up in a different society, with different pressures, and expectations. They did not have to ~~but~~ rebuild their lives from scratch, so they have the freedom to lollygag, socialize, and drift along the current of the culture around them. The pressure their parents felt, and needed to act on, to succeed doesn't quite translate to the tranquility of suburban life. So perhaps the children need not fear the world like their parents did.

Should the child ease up on themselves, the parent, will likely see the same patterns in their child as the many cousins who failed their way into miserable lives. Thus, for the good of the child, they may go to

great lengths to impress on the child the urgency of the matter, the danger of the world. Thus, a disconnect forms, where the child is shown an anxious, fear-stricken perspective of the world at home, and a much less urgent thing in the suburban world. The child, turns to approach that peaceful world with the anxiety of someone foreign to it. I see so many youth, who can't seem to relax, and ease up on their lives because of this. So many youth, who ferrently, pursue some career path without stopping to think about why they want it and how their actions will shape the world around them. So many lost ~~ambition~~ chasing "ambition" in the anxiety of their parents.

If this is you, I want you to consider this "amor fati." The love of one's fate. If you spend your life engulfed in your parents' anxiety, you will likely form a narrow view of what life needs to be in order to be worth living. Things pulling you away from that ideal life then become the things that instill anxiety. If you choose to love your fate, to believe that life is worth living, no matter what it looks like, you may find that there is plenty of potential to live a great life outside of the bounds of what you were told you needed to do to live the "good life." So go forth and love your fate. There is much to experian